LVNA
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VILLAGER

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WHAT'S IN THIS ISSUE

1 next meeting
new board

2 message from the president

3 factoid

6 pet of the month
recipe corner

8 lvna meeting recap

NEXT MEETING

Join us on April 14th, 7:00 – 8:00 PM, for a virtual presentation from the Sunnyvale Emergency Response Volunteers (SERV) team. This is the volunteer branch of Sunnyvale's Department of Public Safety, both teaching classes on disaster preparedness and assisting professional responders during emergencies. This is a great opportunity to learn how to be prepared in case of an emergency and what you can do to volunteer. Zoom meeting credentials will be available 1 hour before the start of the meeting, at LVNASV.org/meeting

NEW BOARD

A new LVNA board was elected on March 10th. We'd like to give a huge shout-out to the previous board members for all of their hard work and dedication to the neighborhood this past year, especially given the difficulty of keeping things up and running over the course of the pandemic. Imelda, Grace, and Linda have stepped down this year, with Bev, Lydia, and Tony continuing for the 2021-2022 cycle.

We'd also like to thank Cortney and Brad for stepping up to fill the openings so we can continue to operate with a complete 5-person board.

Your 2021-2022 board members are:

President	- Lydia Fotiades
1st VP	- Tony Bugna
2nd VP	- Cortney Jansen
Treasurer	- Bev Woidyla
Secretary	- Brad Dux

Board member contact details are available on the last page of this newsletter. The next election will take place on March 9th, 2022.

MESSAGE FROM THE PRESIDENT



Hi LVNA Neighbors,

With the new board just elected, I wanted to take the opportunity to introduce myself as the new president of LVNA and share my view on this role.

I moved to the neighborhood in Jan 2016 with my (now) husband. My husband and I love this neighborhood, in terms of the people, the amenities (the parks), proximity to highways and bike paths, plus great food options nearby!

When we first moved here I really enjoyed reading the Villager each month, to feel connected with the neighborhood, and I was so excited when I received the flyer for the summer LVNA picnic at Lakewood Park. We attended and got to meet some folks from the neighborhood; we were even one of the winners of the raffle and won 2 movie tickets! It was this picnic that made me want to get more involved. After 2017 passed without a picnic I began asking about whether the picnic would be held in 2018 and ended up planning it for that year. It was such a warm welcome to the neighborhood for me that I wanted others to have that same opportunity, not to mention a chance for me to meet more of my neighbors. And I guess that has led me here today, as president.

My interest as president of LVNA is mainly driven by the idea of helping neighbors get to know one another. There are several regular events throughout the year that I hope we can begin planning again, although likely not until later this year. I'm also happy to help with concerns from the community, although please be aware that the board (including myself) is made up of volunteers who all have their own families, jobs, and other commitments. The board is encouraged to participate in the areas that they are interested in, but to not burn themselves out. Unfortunately, I do anticipate areas that we will not be able to cover as there are many different concerns brought to our attention, but the good news is that we are also always looking for volunteers to help. If you are passionate about a particular issue that we don't have the bandwidth to follow-up on, we are happy to put you in touch with the appropriate people so you can take next steps on any concern you have about our neighborhood. If you're inclined to participate even further, we're also always looking for new members to join the board. Most of us are on the board because we're interested in helping the neighborhood, but also mainly because "nobody else wants to do it." If we have any strong-willed neighbors who really want to take charge, most of us on the board (including myself) are happy to pass the torch to anyone who would like to have a go at it. Feel free to ask us more about our roles and volunteer positions, or simply enjoy our events and what we're able to offer. :)

I look forward to getting to know more of my neighbors.

Sincerely,

Lydia Fotiades



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FACTOID

Hopefully you've had a chance to read about radon in last month's Factoid. If not, we suggest you start there for an intro to what radon is and how to measure the level in your home.

Let's say you've made some measurements and discovered that your home has elevated radon levels (over 2 pCi/L); now what? Well, the good news is that there are methods to bring your number down. Since every home is unique and we are not licensed to provide advice on what you should do, we suggest consulting with a radon mitigation specialist to assess your situation and provide recommendations tailored to your requirements.

The most common form of mitigation is sub-slab suction. If you consider yourself pretty handy and are in the mood for a DIY project, this is absolutely achievable and you can save quite a bit of money. In total, the component costs will be around $300-500. Hiring someone to do the work for you will likely run upwards of $2,000. However, if you don't already have the tools and aren't able to borrow from a family member or friend, you'll likely need to rent a couple of them to speed up the job, adding to the cost.

Most of the Lakewood Village homes still have their original 1950s slab. Also, most of the properties were built with very similar construction materials and techniques. We just installed a sub-slab suction system in January so there's a good chance that some of our experiences will directly apply to your situation. If you decide to hire a professional or do it yourself, keep some of these tips in mind while planning your project.

The goal with sub-slab suctioning is to create a vacuum under your house, pulling air and radon from the area under the slab into a pipe, then venting it out the roof. There are a few key requirements to keep in mind:

- For aesthetic reasons, it's ideal to pick a location where the pipe won't be visible.
- A combination of factors will impact the suction abilities (fan power, soil density, pipe diameter, etc.) so it's best to either pick a central point within the home or, alternatively, install multiple pipes/systems with some distance between them to ensure sufficient suction from all areas under the slab. This is where radon mitigation specialists can come in handy.
- The fan must be located either outside (ensure you have a fan rated for outdoor use) or in an attic. In the event that you have a leak on the output side of the fan, this prevents high-concentration radon-contaminated air from being blown directly into the living quarters.
- The roof vent should be at least 10 feet away from any potential entrances to the home, such as doors or windows, to prevent the radon-concentrated air from blowing inside if they're open.

For our home, which is the original 1,108 sqft model, we opted to install a single pipe/system in the middle of

the living environment. Our hallway closet was the perfect spot – pipe is hidden, it's fairly close to the mid-point of the foundation, easy right-angle turn into the attic (area above the hallway), and is still easily accessible to check the manometer for suction power.

After deciding the location, you'll need to determine sizing and power of components. Again, this is where radon mitigation specialists would be very helpful. In our case, we decided to do the research on our own to save some money and reduce the number of strangers coming into our home during a pandemic. After picking a fan, we measured the length of pipe we'd need (4" ABS/PVC), counted the number of joint components, and made a list of the other miscellaneous materials.

Figure 1 shows a high-level overview of what the system should look like in the end. After drilling and chiseling out an opening in the slab, scoop out as much dirt beneath the slab as your arm can reach - ideally, about 20 gallons (yes, this is the most difficult and time-consuming step). Afterwards, you can insert the pipe just below the base of the slab and connect all of the other joints and pipes up to the location of the radon fan. Identify the point in the roof directly above the fan's outlet where you'll drill for the vent pipe. Add the flashing and vent cap (or two right-angle bends) to prevent water from getting in, then seal everything up. Using some couplers, install your fan between the attic pipe and your roof vent. That's it!

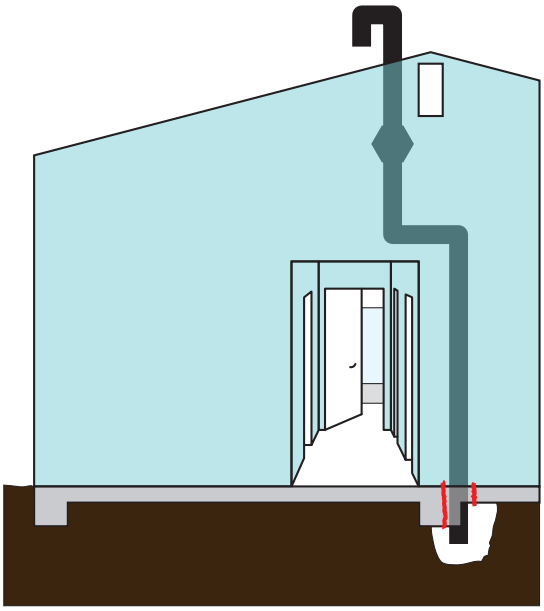


Figure 1. Slice of Typical Lakewood Village Home Sub-Slab Suction Installation

Here's the DIY guide we used as a reference during our project. https://www.familyhandyman.com/list/diy-radon-reduction-system. There are numerous examples online but we found this one to have the right level of detail for our situation.

Some pointers we'd like to mention specifically for Lakewood Village homes:

- You'll notice in the cross-section from Figure 1 that there's a footing in the center of the house. Typical slabs are 4-6 inches thick. Ours is about 8 inches and the footing is over 14 inches. If you avoid drilling within 6 inches of either side of the central beam running through your home, represented by the white rectangle towards the top of Figure 1, you'll likely avoid 6+ inches of additional concrete removal.

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FACTOID

CONT.

- Most of the DIY guides will suggest cutting the concrete hole to a diameter slightly larger than the diameter of your pipe. The soil under our home is extremely compact. We've done enough gardening that we went into this project fully expecting that so, to make the digging easier, we decided from the beginning to cut a much larger hole. This was absolutely worth it!
- When digging out the dirt, use an auger drill-bit to first loosen as much as you can. You'll then be able to more easily scoop it out with your hand. This WILL take a while. Just remember that the more dirt you can pull out, the better your system will work.

In the end, we were able to bring down our average radon level from about 9.8 pCi/L to about 0.25 pCi/L, as shown in Figure 2. If you have elevated levels, as we did, we highly recommend taking steps to reduce it.

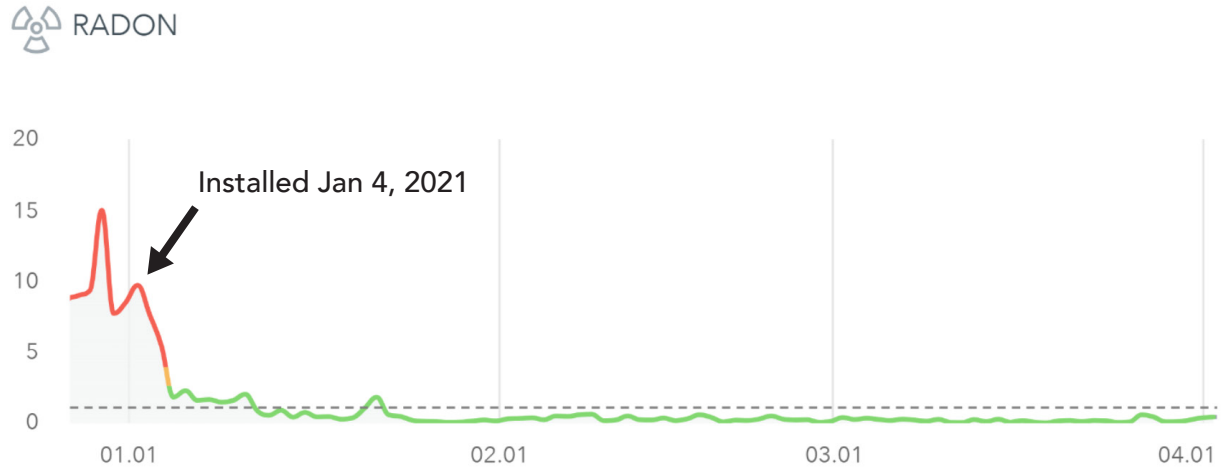


Figure 2. Impact of Mitigation

Here are some pics from during our installation -

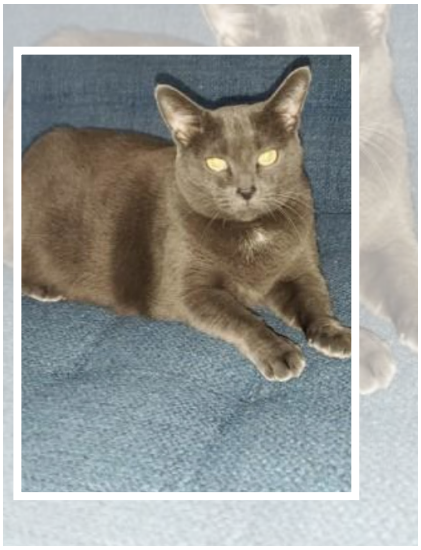









PET OF THE MONTH



Nyla - 8 years old, rescued and transplanted from Modesto. Weighing in at a whopping 16 pounds!! Enjoys life with two past Pet of the Month features...Frank and Char.

Is your pet ready for the Villager spotlight? Submit your caption and photo to editor@lvnasv.org

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ADVERTISE WITH US!

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RECIPE CORNER

Cold Brew

30 gram whole coffee beans, ground coarsely
1 CUP water

1. For cold brew, you want to use the ratio of 1 cup water to 30 grams of coarsely ground coffee beans. In a jar, combine ground coffee beans with water. Stir to combine.
2. Put lid on jar and refrigerate it for a minimum of 12 hours but no more than 24 hours.
3. When ready to strain, use a coffee filter or cheesecloth over a fine-mesh sieve. Place it over a cup/pitcher and pour the coffee/water mixture through it.
4. The cold brew drink is ready to go! Place it in the fridge or drink immediately. Feel free to dilute with water, if needed.

The views, opinions, and facts presented in the Villager are of their respective authors/creators and don't necessarily reflect the views or opinions of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association, its officers, residents or other sponsors.
If you'd like to submit an article, event, etc., for possible publication in a future edition of the Villager, please send an email to our editor(s) at editor@lvnasv.org

Instyle Beauty Salon, located in Sunnyvale-Santa Clara, is offering readers $150 off microblading, a new and popular procedure that creates the perfect eyebrow!

Normally $450, Instyle Beauty Salon is offering readers $150 off, making it just $300 for the procedure – which also includes the touch-up visit that is recommended within 4-6 weeks of the initial procedure.

Manual microblading is a form of a semi-permanent tattoo that involves using tiny needles (instead of a tattoo gun) that make up a small blade to help deposit pigment under your skin, one by one, for natural looking hair strokes. The procedure takes about an hour to 2 hours and lasts 1.5-2 years before needing to be redone to look fresh. Topical numbing cream is used to maximize comfort. Microblading is perfect for anyone with any hair color and is tailored to each individual client.

For more information and to schedule a consultation, call or text (408) 605-2146.









LVNA CONTACTS

President	Lydia Fotiades	president@lvnasv.org
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Secretary	Brad Dux	secretary@lvnasv.org
Newsletter	Ray Family	editor@lvnasv.org
Media	Ray Family	media@lvnasv.org
Advertising	Tony	ads@lvnasv.org

IMPORTANT NUMBERS

Emergency	911
Abandoned Vehicles	(408) 730-7150
Shopping Carts and Graffiti	(408) 730-7680
Animal Control	(408) 730-7178
Neighborhood Preservation	(408) 730-7610
Parks & Maintenance	(408) 730-7506
Public Safety -- General Info	(408) 730-7100
Public Safety -- Non-Emergency	(408) 730-7180

LVNA MEETING RECAP

LVNA MEETING ON MAR 10

Larry Klein, mayor of Sunnyvale, joined us for last month's general meeting to discuss a number of topics and answer questions from Lakewood Village residents. He provided an overview of his background with non-profits and advisory committees, prior to his roles on the City Council and as Mayor. If you weren't able to make it to the meeting, check out the recording for some great info on:

- Funding and grants during COVID
- Exploring the region with his dog, Buddy (Instagram.com/buddyhugz/)
- Larry's restaurant project – visiting nearly 200 restaurants during the pandemic (www.EatSunnyvale.com)
- Lakewood Branch Library status
- Land at Fairwood Park
- Food Cycling
- Recycling market
- Residents without housing (about 700 unhoused in the city)
- City zoning laws
- Theft, vandalism, and other illegal activity

The meeting recording can be found at https://youtu.be/jdCe8PADh9Y

UPCOMING EVENTS

APRIL

14 lvna monthly meeting
virtual Zoom link: lvnasv.org/meeting
7:00 - 8:00 PM

MAY

12 lvna monthly meeting
virtual Zoom link: lvnasv.org/meeting
7:00 - 8:00 PM

For all Sunnyvale events, please refer to Sunnyvale's online calendar at https://sunnyvale.ca.gov/cals/.

LVNA CRV Recycling Drive

Have cans or bottles to recycle? Email us at recycle@lvnasv.org and one of our volunteers will coordinate a time to swing by to collect them. 100% of the funds will be used for future LVNA neighborhood events and expenses.